

Connochaetes taurinus

Blue wildebeest



Length 5–7½ ft
(1.5–2.4 m)
Tail 31–40 in
(80–100 cm)
Weight 360–650 lb
(164–295 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



Previously considered a subspecies of the wildebeest, the blue wildebeest has an unmistakable large, long-muzzled head, cow-like horns, and high shoulders. The single calf is born after 8–9 months' gestation. It bleats like a lamb, and its fiercely protective mother lows like a domestic cow in reply. Males form bachelor herds at 1–4 years of age. They have territories, but females move between them and mate with several males.

DANGEROUS JOURNEY



Although some wildebeest remain in a home range, other species band into large herds and migrate hundreds of miles on an annual journey to find seasonal grazing. The route may be altered by unusual rains stimulating grass elsewhere. At river crossings (above), they are vulnerable to crocodile attack.



horns up to
32 in (80 cm)
long in male

LONG MANE

The blue wildebeest's copious black mane extends from neck to shoulders, and hairs spill over the forehead. The main coat is silver-gray with brown hues fading rearward, and the tail is long and black.

Oreotragus oreotragus

Cape klipspringer

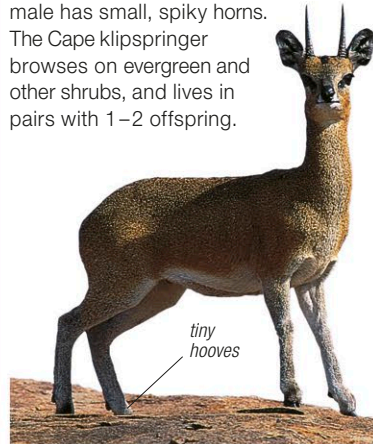


Length 2½ ft
(0.8 m)
Tail 2–5 in
(5–13 cm)
Weight 18–40 lb
(8–18 kg)
Social unit Pair
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



This small, short-muzzled, tiny-hoofed antelope leaps skillfully over the steep, rocky terrain of its native mountains and river gorges. It has a short tail, and the hairs of the coat have white and brown bands and yellow tips, which gives it a rather speckled appearance. The male has small, spiky horns. The Cape klipspringer browses on evergreen and other shrubs, and lives in pairs with 1–2 offspring.



tiny
hooves

Ourebia ourebi

Southern oribi



Length 3–4½ ft
(0.9–1.4 m)
Tail 3 in
(7.5 cm)
Weight 17–35 lb
(7.5–17 kg)
Social unit Variable
Status Least concern

Location Southern Africa



Small, slender, and long-necked, the oribi has fine, silky fur, sandy to rufous above, and white below and on the chin and rump, with longer tufts on the knees. The male has 2 small, spiky, ringed horns. The diet consists of grasses and, in the dry season, leaves. Southern oribi are socially flexible, with male–female pairs or small herds of 7–8 with 2–3 adult males. The male may help to clean and guard the calf, which is weaned at 2 months.

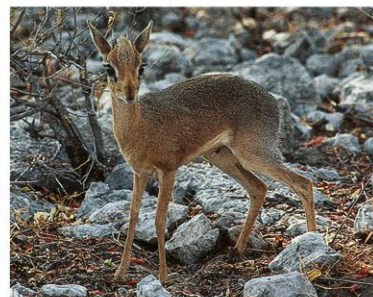
Madoqua kirkii

Kirk's dik-dik



Length 20½–28 in
(52–72 cm)
Tail 14–22 in
(35–56 cm)
Weight 20 lb
(9 kg)
Social unit Pair
Status Least concern

Location E. and S.W.
Africa



The 4 dik-dik species are named after their alarm call. Kirk's dik-dik has a soft, lank coat, grizzled gray to brown, and more reddish brown on the head, with a forehead crest. The rubbery-bottomed hooves grip effectively on rocks. It eats a wide range of plants and lives as a close-bonded male–female pair and a single offspring, born after 169–174 days' gestation. The newborn remains hidden for 2–3 weeks, and suckles for 3–4 months.

Antelope cervicapra

Blackbuck

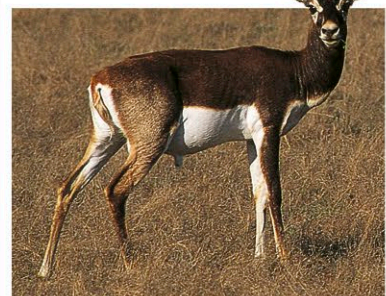


Length 3¾–4¼ ft
(1.2–1.3 m)
Tail 3¼–5¼ in
(8.2–13.5 cm)
Weight 55–75 lb
(25–35 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Near threatened

Location S. Asia



The blackbuck grazes on grasses, including cereal crops. Females are fawn to yellow, dominant males become black with age, and other males are brown. All have a white underside, rump, muzzle, and eye-ring. The male's horns, up to 27 in (68 cm) long, are ringed at the base and spiral up to 5 turns. When breeding, the male defends his territory and harem.

*Raphicerus campestris*

Steenbok



Length 24–37 in
(61–95 cm)
Tail 1½–3¼ in
(4–8 cm)
Weight 15–35 lb
(7–16 kg)
Social unit Individual/Pair
Status Least concern

Location E. and southern
Africa



The steenbok, or steinbuck, lives alone or as a pair with largely separate lives, within a territory marked by scents and dung. It both browses and grazes, and digs up roots and tubers with its

feet, which lack the 2 lateral toes. Its color is bright rufous-fawn, sometimes tinged silver-gray, pale beneath. There is also a white eye-stripe or ring, and black "finger lines" in the ear, patches on the nose, and between the horns, which are present only in the male.

